

E-reader Deprecation Summary

Background:

Around May 20, 2026, 9 legacy e-reader devices were deprecated across 14 marketplaces. Post-deprecation, we lose the ability to track reading activity on these devices. This creates two challenges:

- 1) Author compensation - We need to fairly pay authors whose readers were exclusively on deprecated devices.
- 2) Data integrity - We need to verify the data extract is clean and anomalies don't carry material royalty exposure.

Impact to Customers and Publishers:

- KU Customers: Can retain existing borrows indefinitely but cannot make new borrows on deprecated devices.
- Publishers: Because we lose reading signals from deprecated devices, we will stop paying ongoing KU royalties on them - but will compensate authors for unmeasured reads when a customer's only device was a deprecated e-reader.

Compensation Approach:

We run two data extracts - one immediately before deprecation (May 22) and one after (August 27) - to calculate the delta in pages read for each customer-ASIN pair.

Reading behavior post-deprecation	Payout logic
Pages read increased	Pay publishers based on the PPR for their specific marketplace
Reading stalled (customer only reads on legacy devices)	Pay publishers based on pages unread

Methodology:

We identified every active KU borrow held by a customer in the legacy-device cohort where the title had been downloaded to one of the affected e-readers, scoped to KDP titles.

This came to 193,205 borrows across 73,762 customers and 68,827 titles in 12 marketplaces. For each borrow we measured the "unread payable KENP" - the book's payable length (capped at the KU maximum of 3,000 pages) minus the pages already read and billed in the KDP royalty ledger at two points: May 22, 2026 (depreciation day) and August 27, 2026 (~3 months later), valued at the KDP Select worldwide per-page rate of \$0.00428.

Because legacy devices stop reporting activity after the cutoff, reading captured after May 22 reflects a customer who moved to a non-legacy device, and whatever remains unread represents the upper bound of KU royalty the depreciation put at risk.

TL;DR:

The legacy e-reader depreciation puts an estimated \$76K–\$252K of KDP KU page-read royalty to be paid out - 193K borrows across 74K customers in 12 marketplaces, with US/GB/DE making up ~85%.

Three months past the cutoff, only ~6% of the depreciation-day exposure has been recaptured on other devices, so most of it remains unrealized.

Results:

Bucket	Borrows	Customers	ASINs	Unread Pages (KENP)	Owed \$	What It Means
Progressed (6%)	15,552	10,102	10,959	3,693,645	\$15,809	Reading continued after May 22 - migrated to a non-legacy device.
Stalled (28%)	98,350	35,979	48,107	17,802,821	\$76,196	Actively being read, then stopped around the cutoff.
Never Read (66%)	79,303	45,091	26,769	41,119,869	\$175,993	Zero billable KENP on any device, ever - never read

						to the 10% qualification
Stalled + Never Read (aka “at risk”) (94%)	177,653	71,544	64,339	58,922,690	\$252,189	Full upper-bound exposure - excludes only the migrated borrows.
Grand Total (100%)	193,205	73,762	68,827	62,616,335	\$267,998	All baseline KDP KU borrows with a legacy-device download.

* Owed \$ = unread payable KENP × \$0.00428 WW PPR. Borrows and pages are additive across the three top buckets; customers and ASINs are not (a customer or title can appear in more than one bucket), which is why the sub-bucket distinct counts sum to more than the totals. All figures are upper bounds - legacy devices are dark after May 22, so stalled reading cannot be separated from reading that continued invisibly on the old device.

As of August 27, unread payable reading across these borrows totaled roughly \$268K, down only about \$17K (~6%) from ~\$285K on deprecation day - so most of the exposure remains unrealized three months on.

The residual splits into three tiers: ~\$16K (6%) sits in borrows where the customer demonstrably kept reading on another device and is not at risk; ~\$76K (28%) sits in "read-then-stopped" borrows that were actively in progress and halted around the cutoff, our tightest estimate of reading genuinely interrupted by the deprecation; and ~\$176K (66%) sits in borrows never read to the qualification threshold on any device, the softest slice since those titles may never have been read regardless.

The practical takeaway is a range - roughly \$76K of interrupted active reading at the low end, up to ~\$252K as the full upper bound. All figures are upper bounds: because legacy devices are dark after May 22, we cannot separate genuinely-stalled reading from reading that continued invisibly on the old device, and never-opened borrows are counted at their full payable length.

Marketplace-Level Table*:

Marketplace	KDP KU borrows	Customers	Unrealized \$ (Aug 27)	At-risk \$ (stalled)
US	73,770	27,481	\$99,384	\$92,855
GB	52,793	20,134	\$72,206	\$67,538
DE	39,570	15,590	\$57,041	\$54,540
ES	6,729	3,049	\$12,413	\$12,187
AU	5,855	1,715	\$7,872	\$7,219
CA	5,569	1,782	\$7,348	\$6,768
IT	3,244	1,655	\$4,681	\$4,562
FR	2,179	843	\$3,031	\$2,870
BR	1,530	605	\$1,851	\$1,673
IN	826	294	\$993	\$911
JP	862	529	\$919	\$824
MX	278	86	\$258	\$241
Total	193,205	73,762	\$267,998	\$252,189

Data export requested by stakeholders:

- Comparative metrics: [tab2_detail_000.csv](#)
- Marketplace level summary: [tab1_marketplace_summary_000.csv](#)
- ASIN payout details: [secondary_asin_payout_000.csv](#)
- Data dictionary: [ereader_task1_data_dictionary.md](#)

* Owed \$ = unread payable KENP × \$0.00428 WW PPR. Borrows and pages are additive across the three top buckets; customers and ASINs are not (a customer or title can appear in more than one bucket), which is why the sub-bucket distinct counts sum to more than the totals. All figures are upper bounds - legacy devices are dark after May 22, so stalled reading cannot be separated from reading that continued invisibly on the old device.

FAQ:

Q. What are Realized/Unrealized/At-Risk?

- **Realized** - Payable KENP that was billed between May 22 and Aug 27 - reading that moved to a non-legacy device and earned royalty normally. ~\$17K.
- **Unrealized** - Payable KENP not yet billed as of a given date, valued at \$0.00428/page. Covers all borrows regardless of cause. ~\$268K as of Aug 27.
- **At-risk** - The subset of unrealized where the customer showed no reading progress after May 22 (STALLED + NEVER_READ). Attributable to the deprecation - either genuinely stopped or reading invisibly on the dark legacy device (the two cannot be separated). ~\$252K, or 94% of unrealized.

Q. Do deprecated e-readers still acquire content post-deprecation?

No. Downloads on the 9 legacy device types collapse from ~40–60K/day to zero: the last non-zero day is May 21 (5,622 downloads), and every day from May 22 through the Aug 14 snapshot is exactly zero legacy-device downloads. Non-legacy downloads continue normally (~13–22K/day), confirming a genuine device cutoff rather than a data gap.

Conclusion: No new downloads are supported on deprecated e-readers after deprecation - consistent with expected behavior.

Q. Can we quantify if any ASINs are downloaded or borrowed while they were offline (regardless of devices)?

Yes.

event_type	device_class	ereader_cohort	business_model	weird_events	weird_titles	weird_customers
download	non_legacy	Y	MANAGED	528222	81203	111063
download	non_legacy	Y	KDP	312880	122133	56631

download	non_legacy	Y	PUBLIC_DOMAIN	83319	6191	14853
download	non_legacy	Y	KEP	15077	3579	5375
download	non_legacy	Y	APUB	9673	1092	3614
borrow	borrow	Y	KDP	1114	950	160
download	non_legacy	Y	UNKNOWN	489	445	128
borrow	borrow	Y	MANAGED	339	60	201
borrow	borrow	Y	PUBLIC_DOMAIN	18	1	18

* Owed \$ = unread payable KENP × \$0.00428 WW PPR. Borrows and pages are additive across the three top buckets; customers and ASINs are not (a customer or title can appear in more than one bucket), which is why the sub-bucket distinct counts sum to more than the totals. All figures are upper bounds - legacy devices are dark after May 22, so stalled reading cannot be separated from reading that continued invisibly on the old device.

References:

1. Workbench: <https://datacentral.a2z.com/workbench/query-explorer?queryId=afc04521-c8c3-42d0-b888-264fefa79f55>
2. Updated Workbench with Local Currency Export:
<https://datacentral.a2z.com/workbench/query-explorer?queryId=3fa092bc-80bf-400b-b0dd-6b804ef4dbae>
3. Managed and APUB business model export:
<https://datacentral.a2z.com/workbench/query-explorer?queryId=414d324a-c4d8-4237-a1c8-4f8c51853ee8>